

The most-searched
AI job title in America
is one almost nobody
was tracking.



THE TITLE

forward deployed engineer

38,033 US searches a month - more than any other AI career title

Palantir coined it more than a decade ago.



An engineer who works embedded with the customer.
It stayed a Palantir word for about ten years.

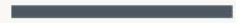
Then it went up

40x

in eighteen months

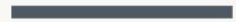
913 → 38,033 searches a month - Jan 2025 to Jul 2026

Four years of US Google search volume.



Every AI job title I could assemble.
1,053 titles. 48 months.

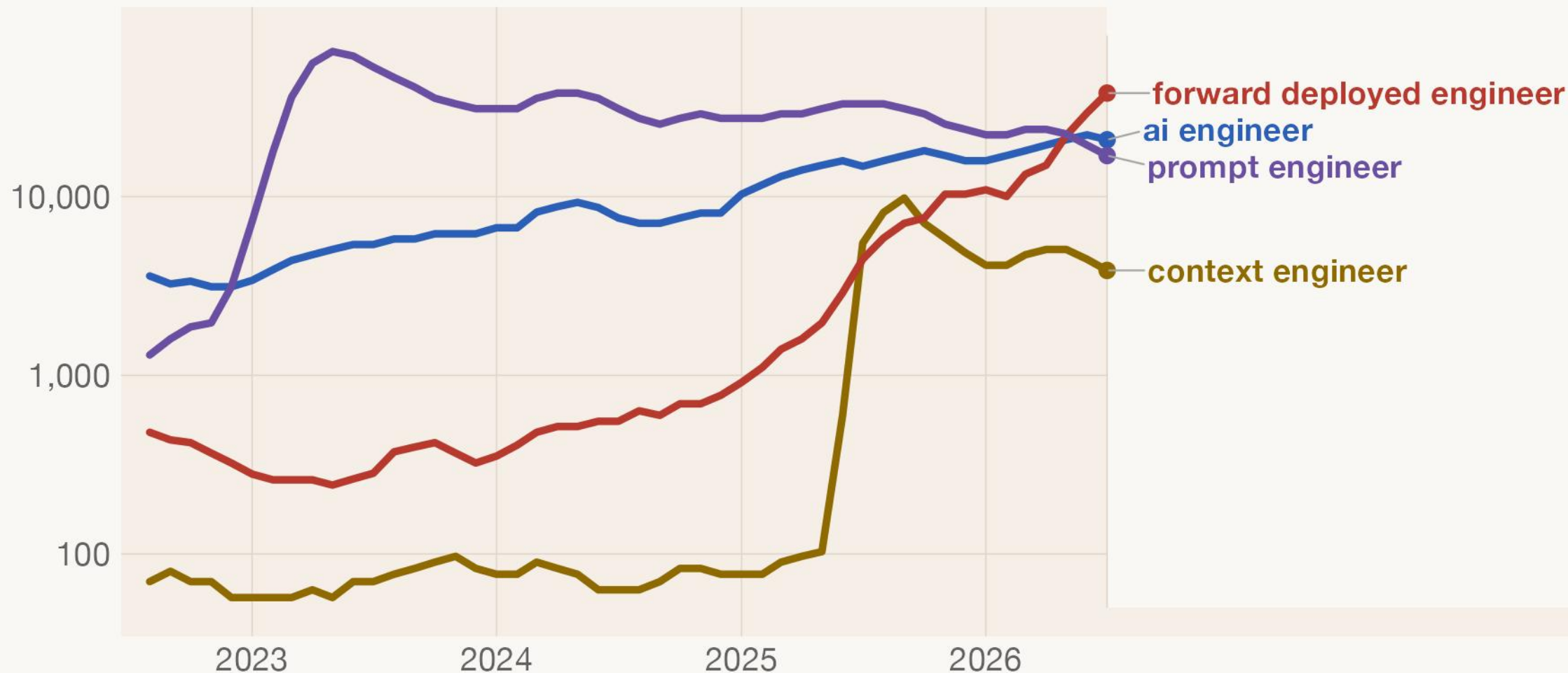
Nobody types a job title
into Google to look good.



It is one of the few honest signals about AI work.

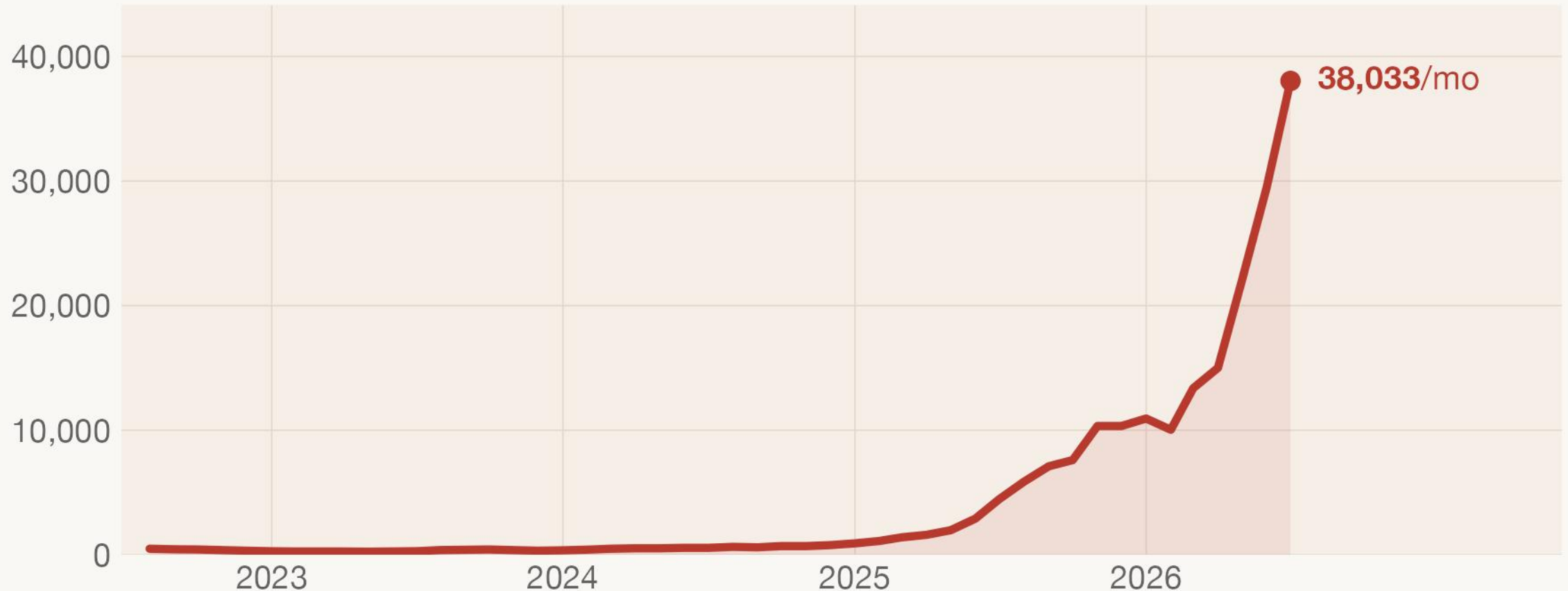
Four titles carry the whole chart

Every AI career title, US searches per month, 3-month rolling average. Log scale.



forward deployed engineer went from an in-joke to the top of the list

From 480 searches a month in 2022 to the most-searched AI career title.



prompt engineer peaked in spring 2023 and has been sliding ever since

The first title to break out after ChatGPT. Down 74% from its peak.



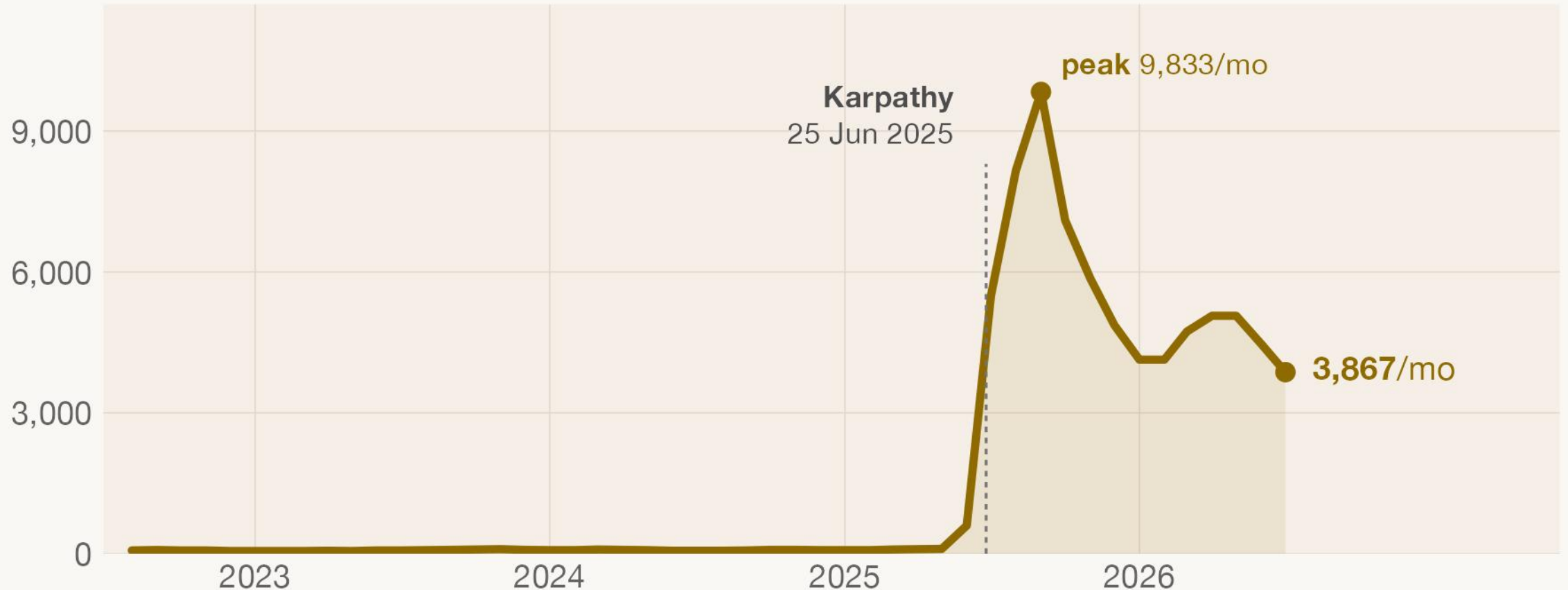


“+1 for ‘**context engineering**’
over ‘prompt engineering’”

Andrej Karpathy · 25 June 2025

context engineer spiked in the same weeks - and gave most of it back

Flat for thirty-four months, then peaked three months after the post.



ai engineer just climbs

No spike, no collapse, nothing to explain. Never more than 24% off its peak.

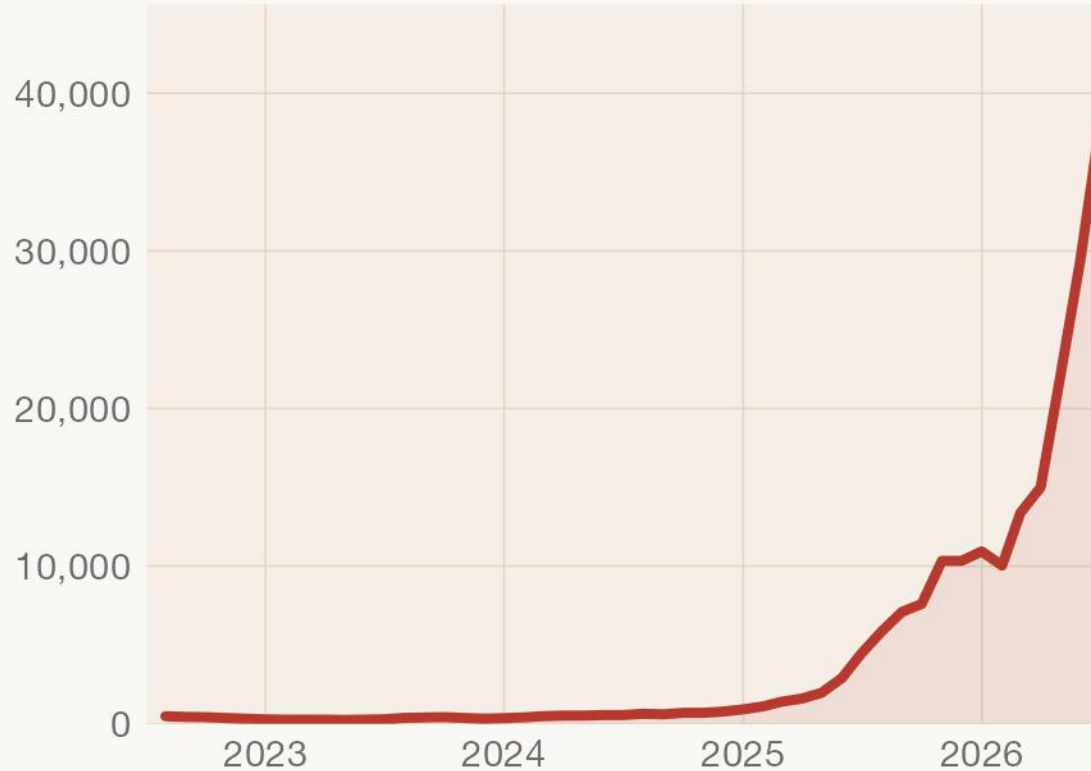


The difference is duration, not slope

Only one of these was still climbing twelve months in.

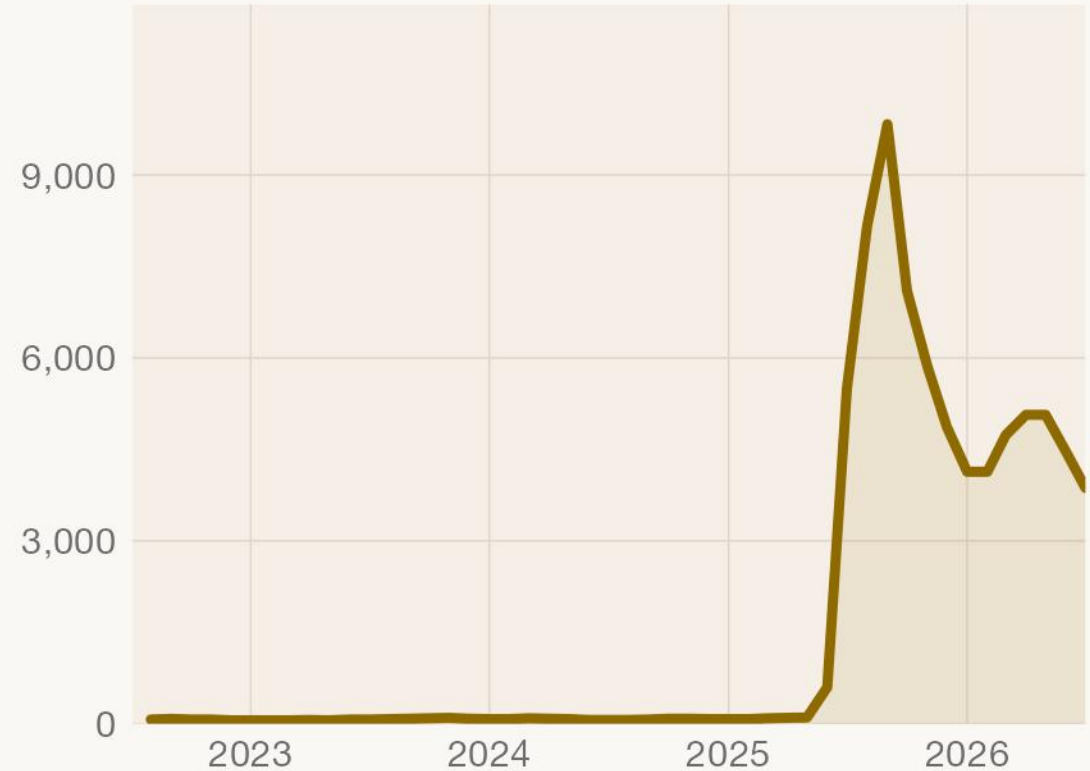
forward deployed engineer

Eighteen months up - and still rising



context engineer

Three months up, ten months down



Standing inside the spike,
the two look identical.

